

Supplemental Materials: Cues, Partisanship, and Willingness-to-Pay for Energy

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Robustness Check: Controlling for Concern about Energy Cost

The main text models the effect of cue condition, political identity, and their interaction on energy-source prioritization and willingness-to-pay (WTP), controlling for age, male, white, education, and income. Energy affordability was a salient concern during the period of data collection: respondents' mean concern about the cost of electricity was 7.88 on a 0 to 10 scale. Because this concern could plausibly confound cue and political-identity effects on prioritization and WTP, this appendix re-estimates every main-text model with concern about energy cost added as an additional control. As shown below, the coefficients, their significance, and the substantive conclusions are consistent with the main text.

The results for the energy source-priority scale are shown in Table 1, parallel to the priority-scale table in the main text.

As in the main text, conservative Republicans were more likely to prioritize fossil fuels ($b = -1.22, p < .001$) and liberal Democrats more likely to prioritize renewables ($b = 0.65, p < .001$). The interaction terms significant at $p \leq .10$ in this specification are:

- Conservative Republican: $b = -1.22, p = 0.000$
- Liberal Democrat: $b = 0.65, p = 0.000$
- Climate cue $\times$ Liberal Democrat: $b = 0.35, p = 0.042$
- Trump cue $\times$ Conservative Republican: $b = -0.41, p = 0.076$

The results for the WTP models are shown in Table 2, parallel to the WTP models table in the main text.

For fossil fuels, conservative Republicans remained significantly more likely than the reference group to have any positive WTP ($b = 0.74$, log-odds scale, $p < .001$), and liberal Democrats less likely ($b = -0.36, p = 0.050$). For renewables, liberal Democrats were willing to pay \$5.30 more on average (climate condition: an additional

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Table 1: Effect of cue condition, political beliefs, and their interaction on the energy source-priority scale, controlling for concern about energy cost (survey-weighted OLS; control condition and other/moderate identity as reference)

	Priority scale
Trump cue	−0.030 (0.157)
Climate cue	−0.122 (0.152)
Liberal Democrat	0.647*** (0.125)
Conservative Republican	−1.221*** (0.148)
Trump cue × Liberal Democrat	0.176 (0.182)
Climate cue × Liberal Democrat	0.354** (0.174)
Trump cue × Conservative Republican	−0.412* (0.232)
Climate cue × Conservative Republican	0.062 (0.217)
Concern about energy cost	0.041** (0.016)
Age	−0.011*** (0.002)
Male	0.239*** (0.068)
White	0.145* (0.078)
Education	0.044** (0.019)
Income	0.020 (0.013)
(Intercept)	5.194*** (0.200)
Num.Obs.	3113

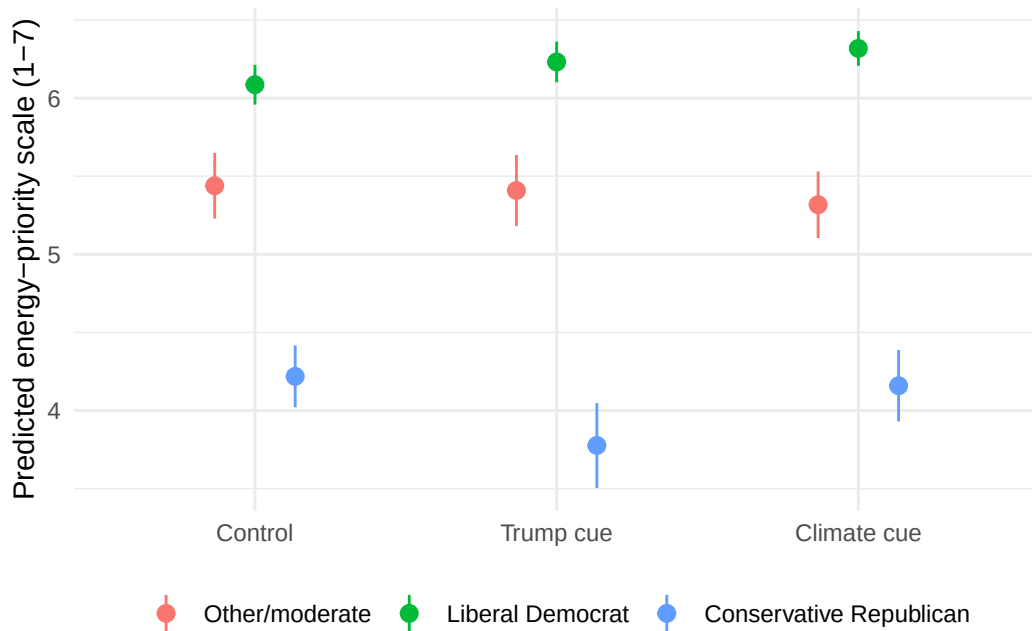
* p < 0.1, ** p < 0.05, *** p < 0.01

Table 2: Effect of cue condition, political beliefs, and their interaction on willingness-to-pay for fossil fuels (any positive WTP, and amount among those with any positive WTP) and for renewables, controlling for concern about energy cost (survey-weighted logit/OLS; control condition and other/moderate identity as reference)

	Fossil fuels: Any WTP (logit)	Fossil fuels: Amount, if WTP > \$o (OLS)	Renewables
Trump cue	−0.252 (0.208)	−3.410 (2.257)	
Climate cue	0.074 (0.206)	−1.148 (2.230)	
Liberal Democrat	−0.362* (0.185)	−0.010 (2.097)	
Conservative Republican	0.742*** (0.208)	−2.897 (2.076)	
Trump cue × Liberal Democrat	−0.029 (0.259)	3.186 (2.870)	
Climate cue × Liberal Democrat	−0.273 (0.260)	1.426 (2.970)	
Trump cue × Conservative Republican	0.424 (0.301)	3.506 (2.918)	
Climate cue × Conservative Republican	−0.024 (0.294)	3.338 (2.876)	
Concern about energy cost	−0.067*** (0.022)	−0.641*** (0.224)	
Age	0.008** (0.003)	−0.002 (0.034)	
Male	−0.062 (0.093)	−0.430 (1.035)	
White	−0.262** (0.106)	0.969 (1.199)	
Education	−0.027 (0.027)	1.148*** (0.292)	
Income	−0.035* (0.019)	0.271 (0.210)	
(Intercept)	0.593** (0.271)	16.788*** (2.958)	
Num.Obs.	3113	1433	

* p < 0.1, ** p < 0.05, *** p < 0.01

Figure 1: Predicted energy source-priority scale (1-7) by cue condition and political identity, controlling for concern about energy cost (survey-weighted OLS predictions with 95% CIs; concern about energy cost, age, male, white, education, and income held at their survey-weighted means)



\$3.66, $p = 0.092$), and conservative Republicans \$6.82 less ($p < .001$) — the same pattern, and nearly the same magnitudes, reported in the main text without this control.

Summary. Adding concern about energy cost as a control does not change which cue x political-identity effects are significant, does not change the sign of any coefficient, and shifts coefficient magnitudes only trivially. The main text's cue and political-identity effects on energy prioritization and WTP are not an artifact of differential cost sensitivity across respondents.

Figure 2: Predicted willingness-to-pay for fossil fuels, among respondents with any positive WTP, by cue condition and political identity, controlling for concern about energy cost (survey-weighted OLS predictions with 95% CIs; concern about energy cost, age, male, white, education, and income held at their survey-weighted means)

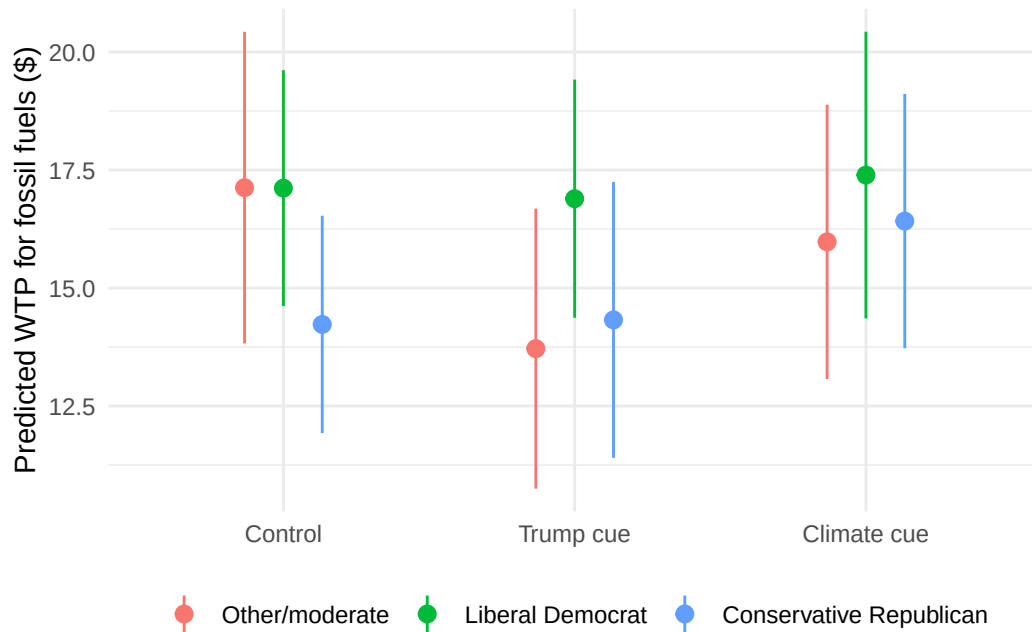
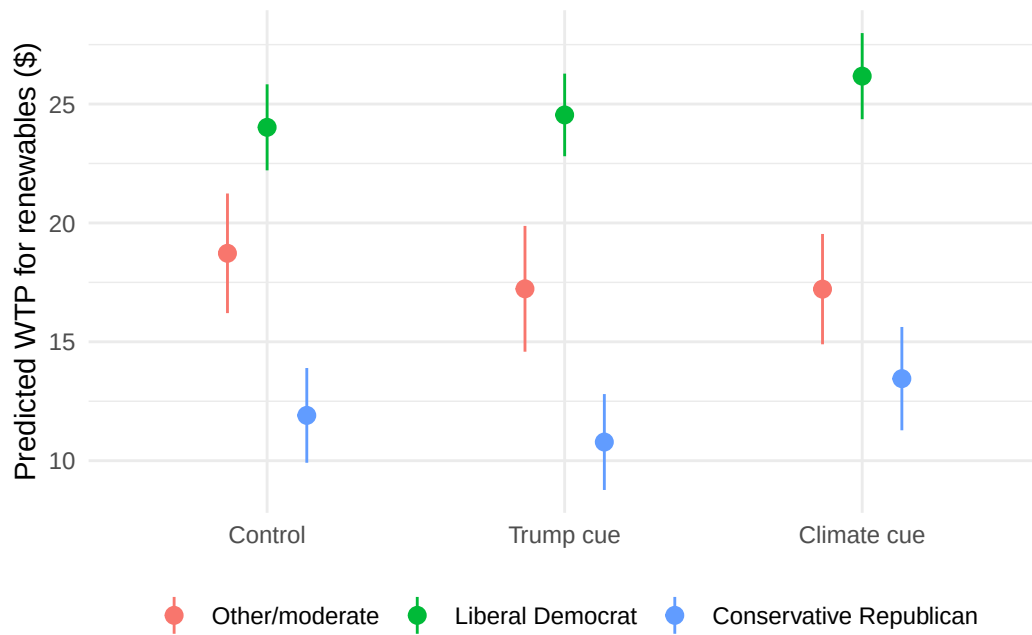


Figure 3: Predicted willingness-to-pay for renewables by cue condition and political identity, controlling for concern about energy cost (survey-weighted OLS predictions with 95% CIs; concern about energy cost, age, male, white, education, and income held at their survey-weighted means)



References